

Taylor McKinney

SOFTWARE ENGINEER



About Me

I'm a seasoned senior software engineer with experience delivering displays that get viewed hundreds of millions of times per day around the world and creating the infrastructure to support it. I'm fluent in both Japanese and client-speak, able to communicate with devs, support associates, and clients with ease. I'm always looking forward to building the next big thing, and take pride in ensuring client satisfaction.

Interests

- Web Development
- Web Application Security
- Computer Graphics
- Game Development

Personal

Nationality: USA
Visa Status: Spouse Visa

Contact Info

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📍 Kobe, Hyogo, Japan

Links

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

06/2023 ~ 09/2025 Senior Software Engineer - Full Stack

REVCOMM INC.

📍 JAPAN - REMOTE

- Built a user management and authentication API, serving a diverse user base of clients, their end-users, and internal staff.
- Engineered and enforced automated security systems that eliminated critical vulnerabilities, preventing potential data leaks of internal passwords and API tokens.
- Pioneered a customizable template system that empowers non-technical team members to manage and brand login pages, removing an entire class of engineering ticket requests.
- Developed and led organization-wide internal technical training courses on core infrastructure (e.g., building tools such as an HTTP server, Redis, SQLite, all from scratch), deepening the developers' understanding of tool internals and improving debugging capabilities.

Tech stack Python/Django, Go, Rust/Leptos, TypeScript/Vue, AWS

05/2022 ~ 05/2023 Senior Software Engineer - Front End

SMARTNEWS

📍 TOKYO, JAPAN

- Developed a highly performant Webview component for the mobile app, enabling the display of dynamic news content and interactive features not yet supported by native components, reaching over 10 million active users.
- Designed and built a versatile WYSIWYG editor using React, with extensible support for vanilla web components and Svelte components. This tool enabled non-technical content teams to create rich, data-driven pages without engineering support, accelerating content deployment time from days down to minutes.
- Created an internal self-service advertising portal, allowing clients to directly manage ads, ad groups, and campaigns, which reduced the support team's operational workload.

Tech stack TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Svelte, Vue, npm, Vite, AWS

10/2020 ~ 05/2022 Senior Software Engineer - Front End

AXA LIFE

📍 TOKYO, JAPAN

- Designed system architecture and built initial prototypes for numerous products and internal applications, navigating internal bureaucracy and establishing scalable patterns adopted company-wide.
- Developed an automated SMS notification system for customer claim updates, improving customer communication transparency and reducing inbound inquiry calls.
- Engineered an internal URL shortener to generate concise links for SMS campaigns, increasing click-through rates by ensuring message clarity.
- Created a universal API authentication gateway, providing a standardized, secure method for all internal teams to protect their services, cutting down initial API development time.
- Led the JavaScript Community of Practices: hosted weekly meet-ups and conducted training sessions for developers sessions on Next.js, internationalization, accessibility, and Redux, upskilling a team of 30+ developers.

Tech stack JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Java, Spring Boot, Python, AWS

05/2019 ~ 02/2020 Systems Software Engineer - Full Stack

NETSMILE, INC.

📍 TOKYO, JAPAN

- Built a client-facing web portal and API service for document upload and OCR processing, streamlining a previously manual workflow.

Tech stack TypeScript, Next.js, React, RabbitMQ, AWS

Languages

English	Native
Japanese	JLPT N2
Spanish	Basic

Programming Languages

Javascript	Typescript	Odin
Zig	Go	Rust
C	Elixir	
C++	C#	GLSL
Slang	Java	
Python		

Front End

React	Vue.js	SolidJS
Next.js	Create React App	
Redux	Webpack	Node
Deno	Bun	Express
Hapi	Vite	
Leptos	Material UI	Ant Design
TailwindCSS		

Testing

Testing Library	Jest	Vitest
Mocha	AVA	Node Tap
Playwright		

Back End

Node	Bun	Deno	Leptos
Axum	Django	Knex.js	
Sequelize	MySQL	PostgreSQL	
Spring Boot			

Cloud

AWS	SQS	SNS	SES	EC2
ECS	EKS	RDS	Lambda	
API Gateway	CloudFront			
Route 53	VPC	S3	DynamoDB	
ElastiCache	AWS Auto Scaling			
CloudFormation	CloudWatch			
Certificate Manager	KMS			
Secrets Manager	GCS	Jenkins		
Circle CI				

Graphics

OpenGL	Vulkan	Raylib	GLFW
SDL2	SDL3		

10/2013

~
02/2019

Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer

BAZAARVOICE

AUSTIN, TEXAS, USA

- Developed and maintained a high-traffic, third-party ratings and reviews application using Backbone.js and jQuery, serving over 400 million unique visitors monthly with strict performance budgets.
- Spearheaded an accessibility overhaul to achieve WCAG 2.0 compliance, expanding market reach and improving usability for all users, while also protecting clients from legal liability.
- Redesigned and optimized the legacy build system, reducing build times from several hours to under 10 minutes and improving CI/CD efficiency for hundreds of client sites.
- Led the Client Satisfaction team: implemented new triage processes and created detailed runbooks, decreasing ticket resolution time and enabling support to independently resolve over 50% of common issues.
- Debugged and fixed critical client-side issues on live production sites, working direction with enterprise clients to resolve urgent problems and maintain SLA compliance.

Tech stack JavaScript, TypeScript, Backbone.js, Node, React, AWS

EDUCATION

2013

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS

AUSTIN, TEXAS, UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

EXTRAS

2012

Paddletronic Duel

BURSTING BRAINS

AUSTIN, TEXAS, UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

Shipped a game on the Google Play store. (It has since been unpublished.)

- Rewrote the AI for computer-controlled opponents.
- Rewrote the physics engine to improve performance.

Gameplay video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mw0MdpC1e8g>